Awl



Category: **Hand Tools - Cutting & Shaping** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Pokar; Tailor's Awl

What it is used for

To pierce, mark, or guide small holes in fabric, leather, or other suitable materials using an awl. To make controlled openings while keeping hands clear of the pointed tip.

Main parts

- Pointed shaft
- Handle
- Grip surface
- Protective cap or sheath, if supplied

Before you start

1. Select an awl suitable for the material and task.
2. Check the point and handle for damage or looseness.
3. Secure the workpiece on a stable surface.
4. Keep the supporting hand away from the intended piercing point.

How to use

1. Mark the intended hole location.
2. Hold the awl firmly by its handle.
3. Place the tip at the marked point.
4. Apply controlled pressure while guiding the tip through the material.
5. Rotate gently only if the material and tool require it.
6. Withdraw the awl carefully and inspect the opening.
7. Cover the point or store the tool safely after use.

⚠ Safety

- Keep the pointed tip directed away from the body.
- Do not hold the workpiece in the path of the awl.
- Do not use a bent or damaged awl.
- Keep the tool covered and away from children.

Care & storage

- Wipe the shaft clean after use.
- Dry the tool to prevent corrosion.

- Inspect the handle and point regularly.
- Store with a protective cap or in a tool holder.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Piercing toward the supporting hand.
- Using excessive force and damaging the material.
- Using an unstable workpiece.
- Leaving the pointed tip exposed during storage.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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